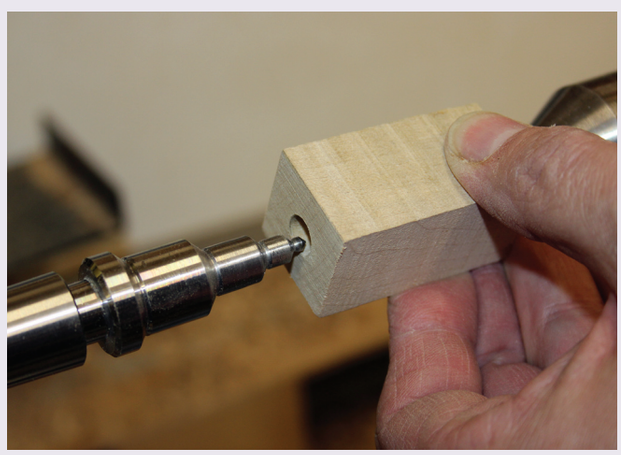
RING CENTRES

Ring centres are the best type if you have to remove the item from the lathe and replace this back in the lathe later; this is due to the drive being a centre point surrounded by a ring. The drive is pure friction; this can be an advantage when learning due to the timber stopping if you have a dig in. With this type of centre, your tool control has to be good to maintain drive.

STEPPED CENTRE

A step centre is the one I use to turn items that have a hole in both ends; this again is a friction drive so good tool techniques are needed or the timber will just spring on the centre. I use this to turn light pulls or is good for any item that you have drilled a hole in the end of.



TYPES OF TAILSTOCK CENTRES: REVOLVING, STANDARD, STEB, RING

The most common tailstock centre is a revolving centre which comes to a point; this is used for most of my turning where I need tailstock support. The down side is it can leave a large hole in wet timber due to the fibres compressing. The revolving ring centre is a good choice with wet timber and also segment work or glued-up pieces such as those for inside out turning. A standard centre in this case can cause the joint to split; a ring centre would prevent this. Mine is part of a set from which I can change the tips in the revolving centre. A revolving steb centre is also a good choice for split turning or turning wet timber. The point on this centre retracts on tightening the tailstock. ●

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